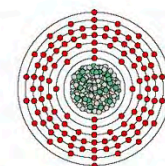


112

Cn

Copernicium



● 112 ⊕ 112 ○ 173



State: Solid
Discovery: 1996

Transition Metals

This statue stands in front of the Polish castle in which Copernicus lived.

Statue of
Nicolaus Copernicus

Some scientists think copernicium could be the **only gaseous metal**.

This German research institute is where copernicium was discovered.



Heavy Ion Research Centre, Germany

The atoms of this radioactive element survive only for a few minutes, before breaking down.

Copernicium is created in particle accelerators by smashing together atoms of lead and zinc. Only a few atoms of this artificial element have ever been produced. Copernicium is named after **Nicolaus Copernicus**, the Polish astronomer who theorized that our planet orbits the Sun.